Introduction

Everyday financial transactions across Bangladesh have changed dramatically with the widespread adoption of mobile financial services (MFS) (Boar & Szemere, 2020). Aligning with national initiatives like "Smart Bangladesh," mobile wallets gave millions of previously unbanked citizens direct access to basic financial tools for the first time (Sarker & Khan, 2024). However, expanding this infrastructure so quickly has created serious cybersecurity issues for consumers and financial platforms (Waliullah et al., 2025). Instead of technical exploits alone, fraudsters often rely on social engineering tricks like fake login portals, phishing calls, spoofed messages, and suspicious apps—to manipulate people into handing over private PINs or OTPs (Hossain et al., 2025). Ultimately, keeping digital transactions safe comes down to individual caution just as much as backend system protection. To address these vulnerabilities, we must carefully examine the actual state of mobile banking security in Bangladesh. Drawing on both empirical data and current academic research, this study evaluates three primary areas: structural weaknesses within banking systems, how user behavior shapes phishing risks, and actionable policy steps needed to reduce these threats.